

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 577

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Julian Taylor Bolton of Memphis.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Julian Taylor Bolton of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Julian Bolton was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on October 28, 1949, in Memphis, Mr. Bolton was the son of Alex and Millicent Bolton; his family moved to Chicago, Illinois, and after completing high school, he returned to Memphis to attend Rhodes College, from which he earned his Bachelor of Arts degree in Communication in 1971; and

WHEREAS, he went on to obtain his Master of Arts degree in Theater from Memphis State University, now the University of Memphis, and began his career in education with Memphis City Schools, later becoming a professor at LeMoyne-Owen College; and

WHEREAS, Julian Bolton was elected to the Shelby County Commission in 1982, serving with distinction for twenty-four years and holding the position of chairman in 1995; he chaired the Budget Committee and Legislative Committee during his tenure and after his departure continued his public service as a policy advisor to both the City of Memphis and the Shelby County Board of Commissioners; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bolton earned his Juris Doctor degree from the University of Memphis and was admitted to the Tennessee Bar Association in 1992; he served as managing partner of the Memphis branch of the Cochran Law Firm for four years before founding his own practice, the Law Office of Julian T. Bolton, and he also served as general counsel for the National

Organization of Black County Officials and special counsel to the Shelby County Board of Commissioners; and

WHEREAS, deeply committed to community service, Julian Bolton served on numerous boards, including the Midtown Mental Health Center Board, the National Association of County Officials, and the National Association of Counties; and

WHEREAS, often duly honored for his good work, Mr. Bolton was recognized with the Rhodes College Distinguished Alumni Award in 2009 and received the City of Memphis Exemplary Service Award from Mayor A.C. Wharton in 2006; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bolton was also wholly devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by his beloved wife of nearly fifty years, Joyce Walker Bolton; children, Julian Taylor (Monique) Bolton II, Jared Walker Bolton, and Jasmine Bolton (Junior) West; granddaughters, Olivia Bolton and Alexis Bolton; siblings, Leah Cornelius, Mattlyn Turks, Kenneth Bolton, Alex Bolton, and Nedra Bolton Bailey; his stepsibling, Marion Mauldin; and a host of extended family and friends; and

WHEREAS, Julian Bolton was a true public servant who impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know him, and he leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we should pay tribute to his bountiful life of purpose and service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Julian Taylor Bolton,

reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mr. Bolton.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.